

## Wave Fellowship Product Case Study – Challenges

Within the context of the 1-week Wave Fellowship, 30 female students from across Switzerland will participate in the fellowship. The fellows will be divided into 6 teams of 5 people, each team being attached to a real product case study.

### Challenge — Financial Independence Retire Early (FIRE)

**Product Name:** Innovate to make financial freedom fun

**Contact people:**

- Arjeta Haskaj (Head of Product Strategy)
- Edwige Fiaclou (Head of Tech Talent & Methodology)

#### Customer problem

In Switzerland, women retire with substantially lower pensions than men, the gender pension gap is around a third. The causes are structural: part-time work, career breaks for caregiving, maternity leave and the pay gap all reduce 2nd-pillar contributions and leave less room to save into the 3rd pillar (3a).

Yet the 3rd pillar is exactly the lever an individual can control. Swissquote already offers InvestEasy and 3a (integrated in the app, 0.50% all-in, five strategies from Mild to Fiery), but most people — women in particular — do not realise how early choices and small regular contributions compound, or how a career break will affect their retirement. The topic feels distant, complex and anxiety-inducing, so people postpone it.

#### Team problem

At Swissquote we offer various investment and retirement solutions, such as 3a directly in the app, but we struggle to make the long-term stakes tangible and personal — especially for younger women whose retirement is decades away.

Design a disruptive, gender-smart experience that makes financial freedom and retirement planning feel dynamic, attainable, and exciting—grounded in the realities women face across life stages.

We also want to understand how to turn an abstract, intimidating subject into something concrete, motivating and easy to act on, so that more people understand the tax benefits as well as the compounding effects of investing. e.g. opening a 3a earlier, contribute regularly and consistently.

#### Product solution

Your solution should help users, particularly women see, simulate, and start their path to FIRE (Financial Independence, Retire Early) and/or retirement in general with honesty and empowerment—not fear.

**Initiatives that support rethinking financial independence:**

- Make actions easy, habitual, interesting and dynamic
- Address fears with data and transparency; emphasizing on control, not perfection

- Inclusivity: language, imagery, accessibility, non-judgmental UX

**Ideas to explore:** model part-time periods, career breaks and the pay gap; visualize the concrete impact of starting today versus in 5 or 10 years; show how a small monthly contribution and the chosen strategy (Mild → Fiery) change the outcome; and nudge users to set up a recurring investment contribution.

**Ideas to Dream Big (Sky is the limit):**

- Imagine a tool that grows with you — adapting to every life stage, automating smart financial decisions in the background, and keeping your long-term goals on track no matter what changes along the way.
- Community, local insights, and a sense of momentum that keeps users engaged, motivated, and connected to something bigger than a spreadsheet.
- Built-in intelligence that turns uncertainty into clarity — helping users understand trade-offs, build confidence through any market, and celebrate progress at every milestone.

*Open to every profile: product & dev (the simulator and flow), data (the model and its assumptions), marketing (how to talk about the FIRE movement without scaring people), and people / behavioural angles (what makes someone act on a 40-year horizon).*

## Value proposition

The Swissquote product that makes financial planning finally feel personal and within reach — showing you, in a few taps (and steps), how today's small choices close tomorrow's pension gap, so no one sleepwalks into a shortfall they could have prevented.